Old Sturgeon

Cousins A neighborhood tale

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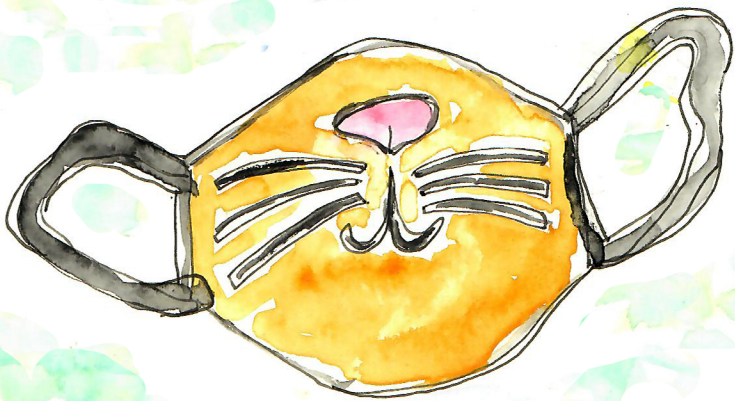


Steller's Jay Jackie was a well-known character in the neighborhood until about five or six years ago, when her business shut down because of COVID.
She had sold inner peace for more than a decade, but when the virus came for a fancy visit, that product suddenly seemed ridiculous. At first, it looked like inner peace or inner light might save you, but pretty quickly the shelves stayed full, and nobody was interested.



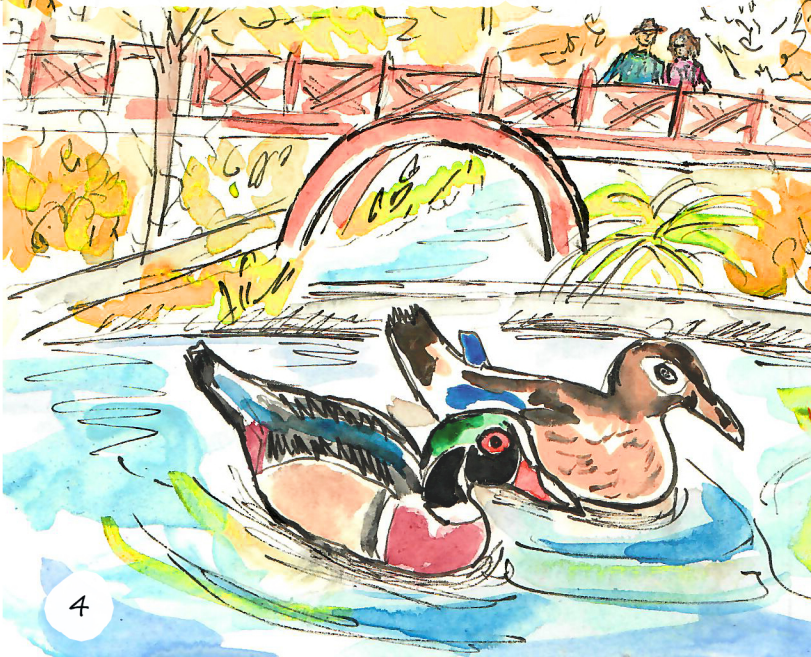
It was a rough time, and on top of it, her cousin, California Jay Sabrina (who had been actually raised in the Bay Area and moved to Portland), bloomed during the pandemic, sewing cat-print masks from daylight to sunset and selling each one for $22!

Now, when I tell you about a bird making cat masks, I'm talking about a powerful, fearless character who cares very little about what is appropriate and what is not.



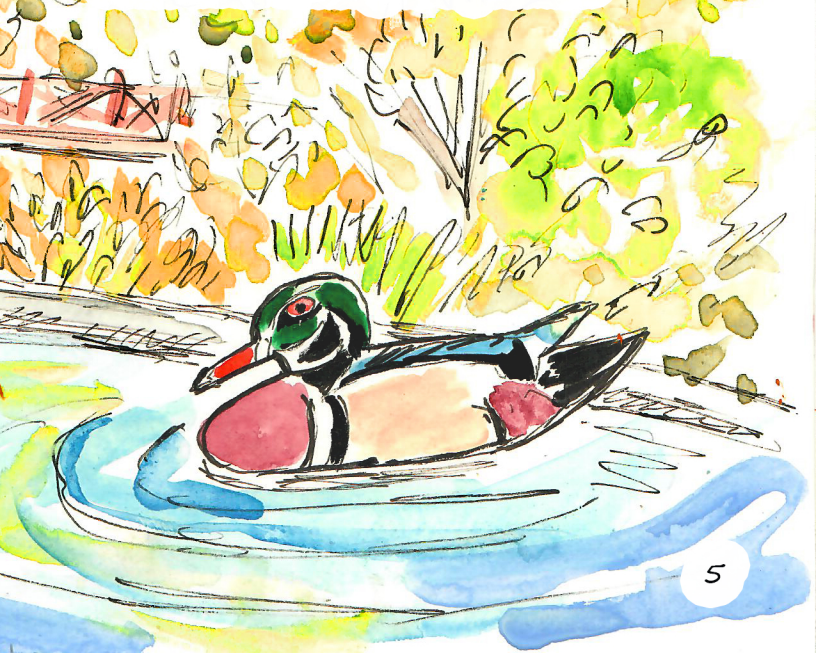
Back to Steller's Jay Jackie.
She moved from her neat nest next to Grand Central Bakery in Sellwood to the Rhododendron Garden in Eastmoreland.

One could say it's not a big deal, or that the sky scene isn't much different, or maybe even that it's a nice upgrade, with all those wood ducks and other water-winged fellows.



But saying that leaves out the loneliness and the humiliation. (Forget about spiritual calm, cosmic glow, or any other power from within.)

And cousin Sabrina had no mercy. Almost all her tweets from then on were very mocking of the idea of the soul's inner activity as a product.



At least Sabrina got older first, while Jackie has kept her beauty well. That's what I call poetic justice. (Jackie from always had the advantage of a crest, of course.) Here's a last-week update: around the bridge in the pastoral Rhodie Garden, visitors turn their heads immediately when they catch her out of the corner of their eyes.



Cousins can have complicated relationships, less so than siblings but still. Complicated because of the parents—blaming them is okay. And a blue bird's blood is a blue bird's legacy, no need to say more. Thanksgiving dinner together? Not so sure yet.



Want to tell us what your favorite Sellwood-Moreland bird is?
Want to tell us something else?
Send us an email! You can write to
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Old Sturgeon zine created by
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